



## HOMWORK 3: STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

### What are Strategic Objectives?

A Strategic Objective is something your church will do to connect with your Target Audience in a way that brings them into a new relationship with your church. It's a way to help you reach your overall Vision and ideally, meets your community's Needs. Working from the information gleaned in your S.W.O.T. analysis, the best Strategic Objectives will be developed to connect with one or more of the following:

- **Capitalize on your Strengths.** You will want to look at the things your church is already doing well and is already positively known for within the congregation and/or community.
- **Address or Improve upon your Weaknesses.** This is your opportunity to bring improvement to struggling or under-resourced programs and may even be the time to reduce the number of things your church is attempting to do. Streamlining and simplifying may be some of the best ways to bring focus to what your church can do best.
- **Maximize your Opportunities.** You may find veins of gold where only nuggets are visible. Your church may be able to take a newer program and expand it or develop a whole new approach to some unmet need that you've identified as an opportunity. Watch for ideas that generate excitement with the Marketing Plan Team and consider if others in the church might be just as excited to help make them happen.
- **Consider your Threats.** While you don't want to run in the face of things outside your church's control, you also don't want to develop Strategic Objectives without considering the realities of the threats you've identified.

## How does identifying Strategic Objectives impact your MARKETING PLAN?

Identifying Strategic Objectives helps you turn your ideas from vague to specific.

*Example:*

*A church known for its strong student ministry (Strength) may realize that this is a program almost exclusively meeting the needs of "church kids" and is not meeting the needs of area students whose families don't attend church (Weakness.) It is vague to say "we should have a better student ministry." A more specific Strategic Objective might be: Expand our student ministry to include easy points of entry and defined next steps to connect with students in our community who have no church connection."*

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Once you establish a Strategic Objective, you can set Measurable Goals and develop specific Tactics.

*Example:*

*(Building on the example above) Within 12 months, have an increase in attendance at our student ministry events by 25 new students per month who are not currently from our "church families." This team may decide that creating new events outside the traditional Sunday morning/evening programs will be a better point of entry for unchurched students. It may be determined that Friday night party/events, following the local High School sporting events is a tactic that will draw students to the doors. From this concept comes additional Tactics for getting the word out – fliers, t-shirts, posters, contests, etc.*

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Your church can develop new teams to take on each Strategic Objectives allowing you get more people involved to meet the goals.

*Example:*

*(Continuing with the example above) Working with your Student Ministry leaders, representatives from the Marketing Plan Team, and perhaps new people with a heart for reaching students, come together to launch this new program/event.*

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Also consider the behind the scenes activities of establishing Strategic Objectives, setting Measurable Goals, and developing Tactics, remember that you will need to communicate thoughtfully with a secondary audience ... the people in your congregation who you'll want to be part of this new marketing effort and who will have to collaborate, share space, work together to make it all a success.

## Review/Respond



Review your S.W.O.T. analysis and considering your Target Audience. Write your thoughts about the questions below.

- What are the **Strengths** that we should capitalize on to connect with or meet the needs of our Target Audience.
- What are some **Weaknesses** we would have to address to connect with or meet the needs of our Target Audience?
- Is there an **Opportunity** to take newer programs that show positive results and expanded them to see even greater results?
- Are there any **Threats** we should be aware of that would shape our plans, either by working around these threats or taking them head-on?

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Are there any Strategic Objectives that combine a **Strength** and an **Opportunity** that could create maximum results?

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